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Rushil Shanmukha Srinivas
EE25BTECH11057
Electrical Engineering ,
IIT Hyderabad.

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Problem Statement

Question : Let P be the plane $3x+2y+3z=16$ and let $S: \alpha\hat{i} + \beta\hat{j} + \gamma\hat{k}$, where $\alpha + \beta + \gamma = 7$ and the distance of (α, β, γ) from the plane is $2/\sqrt{22}$. Let $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w}$ be three distinct vectors in S such that $|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}| = |\mathbf{v} - \mathbf{w}| = |\mathbf{w} - \mathbf{u}|$. Let V be the volume of the parallelepiped determined by vectors $\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{v}, \mathbf{w}$. Then the value of $(80/3)V$ is

Distance between point and plane

Solution :

$$P : \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{x} = c, \quad \mathbf{n} = \begin{pmatrix} 3 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix} \quad c = 16. \quad (3.1)$$

The distance of point $\mathbf{P}_0 = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha \\ \beta \\ \gamma \end{pmatrix}$ from the plane is

$$\text{dist}(\mathbf{P}_0, P) = \frac{|\mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{P}_0 - c|}{\|\mathbf{n}\|} \quad (3.2)$$

Given $\alpha + \beta + \gamma = 7$ and $\text{dist}(\mathbf{P}_0, P) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{22}}$, we have

$$\frac{|3\alpha + 2\beta + 3\gamma - 16|}{\sqrt{22}} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{22}} \implies \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{P}_0 = 18 \text{ or } \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{P}_0 = 14. \quad (3.3)$$

Thus S lies on the intersections

$$\Pi : \mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{x} = 7, \quad \mathbf{m} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (3.4)$$

with

$$P_+ : \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{x} = 18, \quad P_- : \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{x} = 14. \quad (3.5)$$

Each intersection is a line. The direction vector of the line is

$$\mathbf{d} = \mathbf{m} \times \mathbf{n} = \begin{pmatrix} \begin{vmatrix} m_{23} & n_{23} \\ m_{31} & n_{31} \end{vmatrix} \\ \begin{vmatrix} m_{31} & n_{31} \\ m_{12} & n_{12} \end{vmatrix} \\ \begin{vmatrix} m_{12} & n_{12} \\ m_{23} & n_{23} \end{vmatrix} \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \\ -1 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (3.6)$$

Equation of line and finding u, v, w

Pick points: For $\Pi \cap P_+$, solve

$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{x} = 7, \\ \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{x} = 18 \end{cases} \implies \mathbf{p} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 3 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix} \quad (3.7)$$

So

$$L_+ : \mathbf{r} = \mathbf{p} + t\mathbf{d}. \quad (3.8)$$

For $\Pi \cap P_-$, solve

$$\begin{cases} \mathbf{m}^\top \mathbf{x} = 7, \\ \mathbf{n}^\top \mathbf{x} = 14 \end{cases} \implies \mathbf{q} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 7 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} \quad (3.9)$$

So

$$L_- : \mathbf{r} = \mathbf{q} + t\mathbf{d}. \quad (3.10)$$

Construct equilateral triangle:

Take

$$\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{p} + s\mathbf{d}, \quad \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{p} - s\mathbf{d}, \quad \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{q} + t\mathbf{d}. \quad (3.11)$$

$$\|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|^2 = \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{w}\|^2 = \|\mathbf{v} - \mathbf{w}\|^2. \quad (3.12)$$

$$\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v} = 2s\mathbf{d} \Rightarrow \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|^2 = 4s^2\|\mathbf{d}\|^2. \quad (3.13)$$

$$\|\mathbf{d}\|^2 = \mathbf{d}^\top \mathbf{d} = 1^2 + 0^2 + (-1)^2 = 2, \quad \|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{v}\|^2 = 8s^2. \quad (3.14)$$

$$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{p} - \mathbf{q} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ -4 \\ 4 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u} - \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{r} + (s - t)\mathbf{d}. \quad (3.15)$$

$$\|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{w}\|^2 = \|\mathbf{r}\|^2 + 2(s - t)(\mathbf{r}^\top \mathbf{d}) + (s - t)^2\|\mathbf{d}\|^2. \quad (3.16)$$

$$\|\mathbf{r}\|^2 = 32, \quad \mathbf{r}^\top \mathbf{d} = -4, \quad \|\mathbf{d}\|^2 = 2. \quad (3.17)$$

$$\|\mathbf{u} - \mathbf{w}\|^2 = 32 - 8(s - t) + 2(s - t)^2. \quad (3.18)$$

$$\mathbf{v} - \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{r} + (-s - t)\mathbf{d} \Rightarrow \|\mathbf{v} - \mathbf{w}\|^2 = 32 + 8(s + t) + 2(s + t)^2. \quad (3.19)$$

Equating

$$32 - 8(s - t) + 2(s - t)^2 = 8s^2, \quad 32 + 8(s + t) + 2(s + t)^2 = 8s^2. \quad (3.20)$$

$$16s + 8st = 0 \Rightarrow t = -2, \quad s^2 = 4. \quad (3.21)$$

Take $s = 2, t = -2$:

$$\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{p} + 2\mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} 2 \\ 3 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{p} - 2\mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 3 \\ 6 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{w} = \mathbf{q} - 2\mathbf{d} = \begin{pmatrix} -2 \\ 7 \\ 2 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Gram matrix and Volume

Volume of parallelepiped:

Gram matrix G (matrix of pairwise inner products):

$$G = \begin{pmatrix} \|\mathbf{u}\|^2 & \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{v} & \mathbf{u}^\top \mathbf{w} \\ \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{u} & \|\mathbf{v}\|^2 & \mathbf{v}^\top \mathbf{w} \\ \mathbf{w}^\top \mathbf{u} & \mathbf{w}^\top \mathbf{v} & \|\mathbf{w}\|^2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 17 & 17 & 21 \\ 17 & 49 & 37 \\ 21 & 37 & 57 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (3.23)$$

Determinant of the Gram matrix (gives the squared volume):

$$\det G = \det \begin{pmatrix} 17 & 17 & 21 \\ 17 & 49 & 37 \\ 21 & 37 & 57 \end{pmatrix} = 12544 \quad (3.24)$$

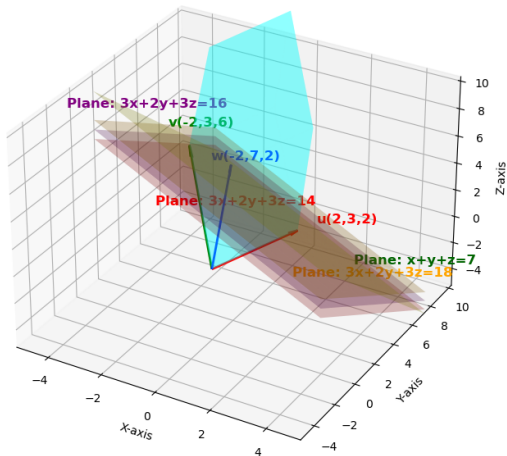
Hence the volume itself is

$$V = \sqrt{\det G} = \sqrt{12544} = 112. \quad (3.25)$$

$$\frac{80V}{3} = \frac{80 \times 112}{3} = \frac{8960}{3}. \quad (3.26)$$

Plots

Vectors u,v,w and Planes



C Code

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <math.h>

// Function to compute determinant of 3x3 matrix
double determinant(double a[3][3]) {
    return a[0][0]*(a[1][1]*a[2][2] - a[1][2]*a[2][1])
        - a[0][1]*(a[1][0]*a[2][2] - a[1][2]*a[2][0])
        + a[0][2]*(a[1][0]*a[2][1] - a[1][1]*a[2][0]);
}

int main() {
    // Two planes:
    // Plane P:  $3x+2y+3z=16$ 
    // Plane S:  $x+y+z=7$ 
    // Solve intersection line between P and S
    // Choose basis for S: let
    //  $a = (1, -1, 0)$ ,  $b = (1, 0, -1)$  both satisfy  $x+y+z=0$ 
```

```
// So general point on S:  $(7,0,0) + s*a + t*b$   
// Constraint from P:  $3x+2y+3z = 14$  or  $18$  (distance condition)
```

```
// Pick "14" first.
```

```
// Solve quickly: Intersection point
```

```
double u[3] = {2,3,2};
```

```
double v[3] = {-2,3,6};
```

```
double w[3] = {-2,7,2};
```

```
// Put in matrix
```

```
double M[3][3] = {  
    {u[0], v[0], w[0]},  
    {u[1], v[1], w[1]},  
    {u[2], v[2], w[2]}};
```

```
// Determinant
```

```
double det = determinant(M);
```

```
double V = fabs(det);
```

```
double result = (80.0/3.0) * V;
```

```
printf(" Chosen vectors:\n");  
printf(" u = (%.2lf, %.2lf, %.2lf)\n", u[0], u[1], u[2]);  
printf(" v = (%.2lf, %.2lf, %.2lf)\n", v[0], v[1], v[2]);  
printf(" w = (%.2lf, %.2lf, %.2lf)\n", w[0], w[1], w[2]);  
printf(" Determinant = %.2lf\n", det);  
printf(" Volume V = %.2lf\n", V);  
printf(" Final (80/3)*V = %.2lf\n", result);  
  
return 0;  
}
```

Python : call_c.py

```
import ctypes
import os

# Load shared library
lib = ctypes.CDLL(os.path.abspath("./libvolume.so"))

# Set return types
lib.get_determinant.restype = ctypes.c_double
lib.get_volume.restype = ctypes.c_double
lib.compute_volume.restype = ctypes.c_double
lib.get_u.restype = ctypes.c_double
lib.get_v.restype = ctypes.c_double
lib.get_w.restype = ctypes.c_double

# Fetch vectors u, v, w
u = [lib.get_u(i) for i in range(3)]
v = [lib.get_v(i) for i in range(3)]
```

```
w = [lib.get_w(i) for i in range(3)]

# Fetch determinant, volume, and final result
det = lib.get_determinant()
V = lib.get_volume()
result = lib.compute_volume()

# Print everything
print("Vector u =", u)
print("Vector v =", v)
print("Vector w =", w)
print("Determinant =", det)
print("Volume V =", V)
print("Final  $(80/3)*V$  =", result)
```

Python Code for Plotting

```
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
from mpl_toolkits.mplot3d.art3d import Poly3DCollection
```

```
# Define vectors
```

```
u = np.array([2, 3, 2])
```

```
v = np.array([-2, 3, 6])
```

```
w = np.array([-2, 7, 2])
```

```
# Origin
```

```
O = np.array([0, 0, 0])
```

```
# Create 3D plot
```

```
fig = plt.figure(figsize=(10, 8))
```

```
ax = fig.add_subplot(111, projection='3d')
```

```
# ----- Plot Vectors u, v, w -----
```

```
def plot_vector(vec, color, label, offset):
```

```
    ax.quiver(O[0], O[1], O[2],
              vec[0], vec[1], vec[2],
```



```
        color=color, arrow.length_ratio=0.1, linewidth=2)
ax.text(vec[0]+offset[0], vec[1]+offset[1], vec[2]+offset[2],
        label, fontsize=12, color=color, weight="bold")
```

```
plot_vector(u, "red", "u(2,3,2)", offset=(0.5, 0.5, 0.5))
plot_vector(v, "green", "v(-2,3,6)", offset=(-1, 0.5, 0.5))
plot_vector(w, "blue", "w(-2,7,2)", offset=(-1, 0.5, -0.5))
```

```
# ----- Plot parallelepiped -----
```

```
vertices = np.array([
    O, u, v, w,
    u+v, v+w, w+u, u+v+w
])
```

```
faces = [
    [O, u, u+v, v],
    [O, v, v+w, w],
    [O, u, u+w, w],
    [u, u+v, u+v+w, u+w],
    [v, u+v, u+v+w, v+w],
```

```

[w, v+w, u+v+w, u+w]]
ax.add_collection3d(Poly3DCollection(faces, alpha=0.25, facecolor="cyan"))

# ----- Planes -----
xx, yy = np.meshgrid(range(-3, 6), range(-3, 9))

# Plane 1:  $3x+2y+3z = 18$ 
zz1 = (18 - 3*xx - 2*yy) / 3
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz1, alpha=0.25, color="orange")
ax.text(4, -3, (18 - 3*4 - 2*(-3)) / 3,
        "Plane:  $3x+2y+3z=18$ ", color="orange", fontsize=12, weight="bold")

# Plane 2:  $3x+2y+3z = 14$  (label at bottom of plane)
zz2 = (14 - 3*xx - 2*yy) / 3
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz2, alpha=0.25, color="red")
ax.text(0, -5, (14 - 3*0 - 2*(-5)) / 3,
        "Plane:  $3x+2y+3z=14$ ", color="red", fontsize=12, weight="bold")

```

```

# Plane 3:  $x+y+z = 7$  (plane yellow, label dark green)
zz3 = 7 - xx - yy
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz3, alpha=0.25, color="yellow")
ax.text(3, 6, 7 - 3 - 6,
        "Plane:  $x+y+z=7$ ", color="darkgreen", fontsize=12, weight="
        bold")

# Plane 4:  $3x+2y+3z = 16$  (mid-plane)
zz4 = (16 - 3*xx - 2*yy) / 3
ax.plot_surface(xx, yy, zz4, alpha=0.25, color="purple")
ax.text(-4, -3, (16 - 3*(-4) - 2*(-3)) / 3,
        "Plane:  $3x+2y+3z=16$ ", color="purple", fontsize=12, weight="
        bold")

# ----- Axes settings -----
ax.set_xlim(-5, 5)
ax.set_ylim(-5, 10)
ax.set_zlim(-5, 10)

```

```
ax.set_xlabel("X-axis")  
ax.set_ylabel("Y-axis")  
ax.set_zlabel("Z-axis")  
ax.set_title("Vectors u,v,w and Planes")  
  
plt.show()
```